

MikroTik fresh build

EUNISET LOVE · nothing on the router worth keeping · reset and build from scratch

Take with you: a laptop with Winbox, the file `mikrotik-setup.rsc` on it (or on a USB stick), an ethernet cable, and a phone to test the hotspot with.

Decide two passwords before you start and write them in Step 2. You will be asked for them mid-way and they are not recoverable afterwards.

Step 1 — the public IP test, BEFORE you reset

Do this first. It is the one thing a reset would make you redo, and it decides whether the online dashboard can ever reach this router.

```
/ip address print
/ip cloud set ddns-enabled=yes
/ip cloud print
```

WAN address (from `/ip address print`)

public-address (from `/ip cloud print`)

What you see	What it means
The two match	Public IP. The online dashboard can reach the router.
They differ	CGNAT. Dashboard cannot dial in; run it on site or via a tunnel.
WAN starts <code>100.64.-100.127.</code>	CGNAT confirmed.

Write both down. Don't try to decide what it means on site.

Step 2 — choose your passwords now

Router admin password

API password (for the dashboard)

Edit these into `mikrotik-setup.rsc` before running it — search the file for **CHANGE-ME**. There are four.

Step 3 — reset

```
/system reset-configuration no-defaults=yes skip-backup=yes
```

The router reboots with **no IP address at all**. Reconnect with Winbox using the **MAC address** on the **Neighbors** tab — not an IP, there isn't one yet. Plug your laptop into **ether2**, not ether1.

Step 4 — load the configuration

Winbox → **Files** → drag mikrotik-setup.rsc in. Then:

```
/import file-name=mikrotik-setup.rsc
```

Watch the output. If a line fails, write down which one and carry on — most failures are a port name that differs on your model (ether5 on a 4-port router, for example). Check yours with `/interface print`.

Step 5 — check it came up

```
/ip address print  
/ip hotspot print  
/ip hotspot user profile print  
/ip service print
```

You want: an address on ether1 from Starlink, 10.5.50.1 on the bridge, one hotspot server running, **eight** voucher profiles, and api enabled on 8728.

Anything that looks wrong

Step 6 — test with a phone

Connect to the access point's WiFi. A login page should appear. Sign in with:

```
username: TEST1234  
password: TEST1234
```

Confirm you get real internet, then check the session is being counted:

```
/ip hotspot active print
```

You should see the phone listed with bytes climbing. Then remove the test voucher:

```
/ip hotspot user remove [find name=TEST1234]
```

If the login page never appears, the usual causes are: the access point is not plugged into **ether2–ether5**, or the AP is running its own DHCP server and should be in bridge/access-point mode instead.

Bring back

- ☐ Step 1: both addresses
- ☐ The two passwords you set
- ☐ The router's LAN IP (should be 10.5.50.1)
- ☐ Router model and RouterOS version (`/system resource print`)
- ☐ Whether the phone test worked, and what the login page looked like

☐ Any command that failed, and its exact message

If you get locked out

You cannot be permanently locked out of a MikroTik you are physically next to.

Situation	What to do
No IP, cannot connect	Winbox → Neighbors tab → connect by MAC address.
Forgot the password you just set	Reset again and start from Step 3. Nothing is lost.
Configuration is a mess	Reset again. The script is repeatable — run it as many times as you need.

EUNISET LOVE — MikroTik fresh build. Nothing here risks data: the router has nothing worth keeping.